

Nick Hall

HEAD OF SECURITY | SECURITY STRATEGY, GOVERNANCE & DEVSECOPS LEADERSHIP

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Head of Security with 20+ years' experience across enterprise technology and cybersecurity, combining security strategy, governance, DevSecOps, cloud security, privacy and hands-on engineering. Leads secure AI adoption and ISO 27001, ISO 27701 and SOC 2 Type II security initiatives, translating complex risk into clear, actionable priorities for senior stakeholders.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP IMPACT

- Secure enterprise AI adoption: Key contributor to introducing artificial intelligence securely into enterprise and DevOps environments.
- Assurance and compliance: Led ISO 27001, ISO 27701 and SOC 2 Type II security initiatives supporting certification and reporting outcomes with zero critical findings.
- Critical vulnerability response: Reduced response time from 9 days to under 24 hours through EPSS and KEV-based prioritisation.
- Security team leadership: Led and mentored technical security teams of 5+ engineers.

CORE EXPERTISE

Security leadership & governance: Security strategy; security governance; secure AI adoption; ISO 27001; ISO 27701; SOC 2; NIST CSF; PCI DSS; CIS Controls; privacy and compliance-led initiatives; stakeholder engagement; security reporting.

DevSecOps & cloud security: DevSecOps; Azure; Azure DevOps; CI/CD security; Kubernetes; Docker; container security; Terraform; infrastructure as code; CSPM; IAM.

Security engineering: Vulnerability management and prioritisation; EPSS; KEV; Trivy; identity management; privileged access management; PKI; multi-vendor firewalls; WAFs; proxies; IPS; Python security automation; Splunk; FortiSIEM.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Security | Mitto AG | Jan 2022 - Present

Leads security strategy, governance and engineering initiatives across secure AI adoption, compliance, DevSecOps, vulnerability management and cloud-native security.

- Key contributor to introducing artificial intelligence securely into enterprise systems and DevOps workflows.
- Led ISO 27001, ISO 27701 and SOC 2 Type II security initiatives, supporting certification and reporting outcomes with zero critical findings.
- Built a vulnerability prioritisation capability using Trivy, EPSS and KEV intelligence, reducing critical vulnerability response time from 9 days to under 24 hours.
- Embedded DevSecOps controls into CI/CD and Kubernetes environments across development, testing and production; reduced deployment vulnerabilities by 73%.
- Developed executive-level security reporting dashboards and shift-left security practices across the software development lifecycle.
- Implemented privileged access management controls to strengthen access governance and reduce organisational risk exposure.

Security Solutions Architect | Dimension Data / NTT | May 2018 - Dec 2021

Security architecture and advisory delivery across OT/IT, SD-WAN and cloud migration environments.

- Designed industrial firewall and OT/IT segmentation architectures using Purdue Model security principles and next-generation threat detection.
- Architected SD-WAN security frameworks for multinational environments with standardised security policies, reducing security incidents by 64% while lowering operational costs.
- Developed secure cloud migration reference architectures incorporating automated compliance controls, CSPM and IAM frameworks.

- Built security control matrices bridging IT and OT environments, enabling compliance objectives while maintaining 99.99% operational uptime.
- Led security workshops and governance sessions with senior stakeholders, translating architecture decisions into business value and risk reduction.

Security Engineer L3 / MSSP Team Lead | Dimension Data | Jan 2013 - May 2018

Senior security engineering delivery for enterprise MSSP clients.

- Led and mentored technical teams of 5+ engineers, improving delivery standards, capability and team morale.
- Managed security operations across 100+ network security devices, including firewalls, WAFs, proxies and IPS platforms.
- Oversaw enterprise PKI infrastructure with 99.999% availability through multi-tier hierarchical designs.
- Led disaster recovery testing for mission-critical environments, achieving 100% recovery success and reducing RTO/RPO by 60%.

Network Engineer | The McGraw-Hill Companies, United Kingdom | Jul 2004 - Dec 2012

EMEA network infrastructure and enterprise networking delivery.

- Supported 12+ European office locations as a primary technical networking resource.
- Led routing, switching and infrastructure refresh work across international environments.
- Managed data centre, WAN optimisation and telephony infrastructure.

PROFESSIONAL CONTRIBUTION

Advisory Board Member | Centre for Research in Information and Cyber Security (CRICS) and School of ICT, Nelson Mandela University | May 2018 - Jan 2022

Guided and mentored the next generation of cybersecurity professionals through advisory board involvement.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) - March 2020
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) - November 2024
- Certified DevSecOps Professional (CDP) - December 2023
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals - April 2021
- Certified SAFe 4 Agilist - September 2018
- Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP) - 2012 to 2018